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SOUTH BEND TRIBUNE

McGuire dies after long illness

By ARNIE STAPLETON
Associated Press Writer

MILWAUKEE — Al McGuire, the charismatic New Yorker who coached Marquette to a national championship and later brought his streetwise lingo to the broadcast booth, died Friday at 72.

The Hall of Fame coach died of a blood disorder, his brother, Dick, said in a telephone interview from Dix Hills, N.Y.

McGuire was regarded as a transcendent communicator in his careers as coach and broadcaster.

"We lost a giant and a genius," said CBS announcer Dick Enberg, a longtime friend and colleague. "Al was the most unique and incredible person I ever met. He saw life at a different angle than the rest of us. He could cut through all of the fat and get to the bone of the matter quicker than anyone I've ever known."

Former North Carolina coach Dean Smith said McGuire never got the credit for his coaching acumen, "because he didn't use the same Xs and Os as many other coaches did. Al was a maverick. He did it his way."

McGuire was one of college basketball's most successful coaches for 26 years, leading Marquette to 11 postseason appearances, capped with an NCAA title in 1977.

When the Warriors beat North Carolina to win the championship in Atlanta, McGuire did not join the celebration. He sat on the bench by himself, his face buried in his hands, crying. He retired shortly thereafter.

"On a campus with great scholars, I had great, great teachers here but none better than him," said Utah basketball coach Rick Majerus, a Marquette alumnus who served as McGuire's assistant in the 1970s and was head coach in the 1980s.

When McGuire retired last March after 25 years as a broadcaster, he said he had a form of anemia but was not more specific.

Majerus, who is taking a sabbatical in Milwaukee to care for his ill mother and recuperate from a heart operation, said he last saw McGuire on Wednesday night, when he brought him a big hamburger and a hot fudge sundae.

"That will be the last great memory," Majerus said. "He said he had n't eaten most in 12 days."

McGuire had removed the intravenous lines supplying drugs and blood transfusions and was facing death with dignity, Majerus said.

"He was just so happy to be free and he was not hindered by those things," Majerus said. "It was as if he was unfettered — spiritually as well as physically."

McGuire played at St. John's before a brief NBA career that ended in the 1954-55 season. He then made his mark on the sport as a coach and broadcaster, earning him election to the Hall of Fame in 1992.

"He was fun to be with, not fun to play against," said former St. John's coach Lou Carnesecca, a schoolmate of McGuire's.

His head coaching career started at Belmont Abbey, a small school in North Carolina, in 1957, and he moved to Marquette in 1964. He stayed for 13 seasons.

He joined NBC in 1977, and his constant banter with fellow analyst Billy Packer became a staple for college basketball fans. "McGuireisms" such as "tap city," "white-knuckler" and "aircraft carrier" became part of the sport's vocabulary.

In McGuire's argot, a "thoroughbred" who was "dynamite" in practice and mediocre at "curtain time" was a "3 o'clocker."

"Al was never a professional broadcaster, so anything that he did on air was not contrived," Packer

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A look at Al McGuire
■ Name: Alfred James McGuire.
■ Age: 72 (Born Sept. 7, 1928. Died Jan. 26, 2001).
■ Alma Mater: St. John's.
■ NBA playing career: New York Knicks (1951-54); Baltimore Bullets (1954-55).
■ Coaching career: Dartmouth (1955-57); Belmont Abbey (1957-64); Marquette (1965-77). Retired from coaching after winning NCAA Championship in his last game.
■ Television analyst: 1977-2000.

AP Photo/ROBERTO BOREA

Baltimore safety Rod Woodson, left, and running back Jamal Lewis share a laugh before the start of Friday's Super Bowl practice.

Springer's coming, too? Just Super

Is Sunday the last game of the NFL's season or the first game of the XFL's?

Given the type of dysfunction on display by the Baltimore Ravens and New York Giants this week in Tampa, hard to tell.

Vince McMahon would love this stuff. It's exactly the lowest-common-denominator image the XFL aspires to sell.

Baltimore struts into town following its unrepentant convict of a linebacker, Ray Lewis, and his Al Sharpton-doll of a teammate, Shannon Sharpe.

Sorry? Ray Lewis sorry? For what, riding away in a limo a year ago while two guys bled to death? Ancient history, man. Atlanta mayor's fault, man. Gonna find the real killers one day, man.

Yeah, right. Ray Maybe you can hire O.J.'s detectives.

Stop persecuting Lewis, Sharpe-ton says.

Yeah, you "reprehensible ambulance-chasers," warns the Ravens' smug walking thesaurus of a coach, Brian Billick.

Billick, who sounds like he would take credit for inventing the Internet if somebody hadn't beaten him to it, obviously believed that if he talked long enough this week something intelligible and intelligent might come out of his mouth.

So far he was wrong.

What's another word for pompous know-it-all, coach?

Good thing the Giants are normal.

All they have is a quarterback, Kerry Collins, who was run out of town in Charlotte after he uttered a racial slur during a drunken binge. He eventually landed in New Orleans, where he was bounced after a DUI charge. Penny-ante stuff, compared to Lewis.

The reformed Collins spent his first day in Tampa talking more about his 13-step program than any seven-step drop. See, along the way, Collins announced he is an alcoholic. Took his first drink at 14. Blames football. Blames his dad.

Did we mention the whole estranged Collins clan plans to gather Sunday in Tampa like one big happy family?

Rumor has it Jerry Springer is sending a camera crew along, too, just in case somebody throws a lamp.

With an alcoholic and a convict at center stage Sunday, come to think of it, if TV ratings are down this year it's only because nobody bothered to put Nielsen ratings boxes in American halfway houses.

This is the kind of reality TV only a mother of a FOX-TV producer could love.

But besides Collins, not many other Giant storylines threaten to keep America rapt with curiosity. If this team were a miniseries, nobody would watch the second night.

They have a pretty bland head coach, Jim Fassel, who seems sort of like Fred Rogers with an attitude. They have an offensive lineman, Glenn Parker, who sips fine wine, which is like a rhinoceros that uses a fork. They have a tailback named Tiki (Barber) and a receiver named Amani (Toomer).

Other than that, the Giants best-known defensive player, Jason Sehorn, for good-news sakes, is better known as Mr. Angie Harmon. Sehorn's fiancee, Ms. Harmon, is

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DAVID HAUGH
COMMENTARY
Seen Mondays and Thursdays on NEWS22 at 6.

Super Bowl
■ Who: Baltimore Ravens and New York Giants.
■ Where: Raymond James Stadium, Tampa, Fla.
■ When: 6:18 p.m., Sunday

H.S. BASKETBALL

Tribune Photo/SANTIAGO FLORES

LaSalle's Maurice Williams picks up a loose ball after Riley's Martell Taylor stumbles during Friday night's Northern Indiana Conference high school game.

Williams grabs spotlight

Makes sure McKnight's 33 isn't wasted

By MATT KOPSEA
Tribune Staff Writer

SOUTH BEND — LaSalle High basketball player Brandon McKnight didn't mind sharing the spotlight Friday night.

McKnight finished with a game-high 31 points, but Maurice Williams' layup with 16.7 seconds saved the day as visiting LaSalle held on for a 74-73 victory over Riley in thrilling Northern Indiana Conference action.

After working the ball around and the clock down, Williams' heroics provided the Lions (5-4, 3-2 NIC) with a three-point cushion.

However, the on-court celebration could not commence until after Riley's Martell Taylor had his 3-point attempt bounce off the front of the rim.

Mark Wilson's rebound basket with one-tenth of a second remaining left the Wildcats (9-4, 3-1 NIC) no time for a miracle comeback.

"Brandon (McKnight) definitely put on a show out there tonight, but he could not have done it without the help of the other four guys on the court," said a jubilant LaSalle coach Mark Johnson. "We always stress the importance of teamwork and thanks to tremendous performances from people like Maurice Williams, Adam Schweitzer, David Staples, and Yyvrut Vann, we were able to pull together tonight to get the job done.

Although both squads had not seen action since Jan. 12, LaSalle showed no ill effects by racing out to an 8-0 advantage and holding the Wildcats without a shot attempt in the process.

With 14 opening quarter points from the Purdue bound McKnight, the Lions led by as many nine points on a couple of occasions before Riley showed signs of awakening.

Senior Mark Woodmore provided a huge lift with 12 of his 14 points in the

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Cougars 'Iron Five' blasts Bremen

By MIKE SIROKY
Tribune Staff Writer

NEW CARLISLE — New Prairie brought the iron and whammed Bremen, 65-56, Friday night in a Northern State Conference boys basketball tussle.

Here's the Lions' 5-7 season in a microcosm: It took the whole first quarter to score five points. They then scored five points in the final frantic 10 seconds.

"We have talked about how it takes us 10-12 minutes to get going," said Bremen coach Gary Hudson. "We have worked very hard and we have talked, the team has talked and we've talked about inexperience. Hey, this is 12 games; inexperience is no longer an issue."

The Cougars (7-4) start five seniors. Bremen starts two, with a junior and two sophomores.

New Prairie coach Harry Beebe calls his starters "The Iron Five."

"We went with the Iron Five in the fourth quarter," he said. "This was a rough week of practice. We only had one practice where everybody dressed and that was Thursday. The flu. I was very concerned. Almost everyone was sick and that includes me. We'd shoot a few free throws and go home.

"Two guys didn't get sick and one of them was Jon Rhine."

He's one of the Iron Five. He scored all of his 19 in the second half. Classmate Nick Szczypiorski got the game going. With two minutes to go in the first half, Szczypiorski had outscored

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N.D. BASKETBALL

Irish, Hoyas battle for first

By TOM NOIE
Tribune Staff Writer

WASHINGTON — In a town so tantalized over the arrival of a new administration, the old Georgetown regime and memories of 'Hoya Paranoya' have been rekindled.

Following too many average efforts — five years have passed since the last NCAA Tournament win — the Hoyas are back among the nation's best. That thanks to a revolving-door rotation of 11 contributors who are all able to run the floor, pressure opponents and score points.

Georgetown, ranked No. 10 this week by the Associated Press, is 17-1 following Thursday's home victory over UNLV. The Hoyas, 4-1 in the Big East West Division, host Notre Dame (12-5, 4-2) today at the MCI Center, where a capacity crowd is anticipated.

The winner moves into sole possession of first place.

"Pretty cool," Irish All-America Troy Murphy said of a chance to play for the top spot. "I remember it was a big deal (last season) when we won our first two games in conference. Now it keeps getting better and better."

Notre Dame looks to win its fourth consecutive conference game for only the second time in school history. This starts a stretch where the Irish, who have lost three consecutive road games, play four of their next five away from home.

"You can't put your finger on what it is, but it's definitely something we have to correct," Murphy said of the road woes. "Four out of five is tough, but what can

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Notre Dame vs. Georgetown
■ Site: MCI Center (20,600).
■ Tipoff: 12 p.m.
■ Television: WNDU-TV (Ch. 16).
■ Radio: WNDV-AM 1490; WNDV-FM 92.9; WEMI 95.9. All Notre Dame games can also be heard via the World Wide Web at www.und.com.

BIG TEN BASKETBALL

I.U.-Iowa drips with subplots

By CURT RALLO
Tribune Staff Writer

The last time Iowa's Luke Recker was on a basketball court with Dane Fife and Kirk Haston, he wore an Indiana Hoosiers uniform.

The last time Iowa's Duez Henderson was on a basketball court with Fife, he wore Fife's teeth marks on his arm.

The last time Iowa's Steve Alford coached against his alma mater, the man who wore red sweaters — Bob Knight — dominated the Hoosier sideline.

Plenty will be different today when Iowa hosts Indiana. Recker will be playing against the Hoosiers for the first time since his emotional transfer from Indiana two years ago.

Another reunion will feature Henderson and Fife, who were high school buddies and tangled in last season's game. Henderson was holding Fife down and Fife bit Henderson to get loose and join a fast break. That led Fife to say later: "Hawkeye tastes like chicken."

Alford, a former Indiana star, will have Mike Davis as his coaching counterpart instead of his former coach. Davis took over as the Hoosiers' interim coach after

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Indiana vs. Iowa
■ When: 1 p.m. (EST) today
■ Where: Carver-Hawkeye Arena, Iowa City, Iowa
■ Records: Indiana 12-8 overall, 3-3 Big Ten; Iowa 15-4 overall, 4-2 Big Ten
■ TV: CBS

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